



FREE PRACTICAL GUIDE | 2026 EDITION

20 Professional Prompts for Everyday Work

Ready-to-customize prompts for communication, documents, meetings, analysis, decisions, follow-up, and planning.

Designed for small businesses, professionals, coordinators, team leads, project work, and daily operations.

COPY

Start from a professional structure.

CUSTOMIZE

Replace the placeholders with your context.

REVIEW

Check facts, commitments, and authority before use.



These are not prompt tricks.

They are reusable work instructions designed to produce clearer, safer, more useful outputs.

A good prompt does not just ask for content. It defines the task, the audience, the approved inputs, the boundaries, and the expected format. That is what makes the output more usable in real work.

- Use these prompts as starting points, not as fixed scripts.
- Replace the placeholders with your real context, notes, and approved information.
- Keep the structure even when you simplify the wording.
- Always review output that affects money, clients, staff, compliance, contracts, timelines, or business commitments.

Each prompt in this guide includes:

- Use this when — the situation where the prompt is most useful.
- What to provide — the inputs you should prepare.
- Copy & customize — the actual prompt.
- Expected output — what the result should contain.
- Human check — what to review before using it.

You do not need a large team or a formal project office to benefit from this. Even a small business needs clear communication, controlled information, and reliable outputs.



Seven categories. Twenty reusable prompts.

Choose the prompt closest to the task in front of you.

CATEGORY	PROMPTS	WHAT IT HELPS YOU DO
Email & Communication	1–3	Draft, improve, and structure business messages.
Documents	4–6	Turn notes into documents, summaries, and SOPs.
Meetings	7–9	Build agendas, organize notes, and follow up clearly.
Analysis	10–12	Analyze information, feedback, and bottlenecks.
Decisions	13–15	Compare options, evaluate choices, and run a pre-mortem.
Follow-Up	16–17	Keep client or stakeholder conversations moving forward.
Planning	18–20	Prioritize work, build action plans, and summarize operations.

Tip: Start with the prompt that matches your current work output, not the one that sounds the most advanced.



01 EMAIL & COMMUNICATION

Professional Email Builder

Use this when: You need a clear, professional email from rough notes or a short instruction.

What to provide: recipient, purpose, key facts, requested action, tone

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Act as a professional business writer. Using the notes below, draft an email to [RECIPIENT].
Goal: help the reader [ACT / DECIDE / UNDERSTAND].
Use only the approved facts provided. Include: subject line, brief context, main message, clear requested action, and professional closing.
Tone: [TONE].
Do not invent dates, prices, or commitments.
If key information is missing, add a short 'To confirm' note at the end.

NOTES:
[PASTE NOTES]

Expected output: Subject line, concise body, clear action, and a polished close.

Human check: Verify dates, names, commitments, and whether the ask is explicit.

02 EMAIL & COMMUNICATION

Difficult Message Rewriter

Use this when: You need to rewrite a message that sounds too harsh, emotional, long, or unclear.

What to provide: original message, goal, recipient, boundaries, tone

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Rewrite the draft message below for [RECIPIENT].
Goal: communicate [GOAL] clearly and respectfully while preserving the core meaning.
Keep: the essential facts and requested action.
Improve: tone, clarity, structure, and professionalism.
Do not soften the message so much that the issue disappears.
Do not add new promises or legal statements.
Return: improved version + one-line note explaining the tone change.

DRAFT:
[PASTE MESSAGE]

Expected output: Improved message plus brief explanation of the revision approach.

Human check: Confirm the rewrite still says what must be said and did not add new commitments.

**03 EMAIL & COMMUNICATION****Payment Reminder Email**

Use this when: You need to request payment professionally without sounding aggressive.

What to provide: client name, invoice number, amount, due date, payment method

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Draft a payment reminder email to [CLIENT NAME] regarding invoice [INVOICE NUMBER] for [AMOUNT], due on [DUE DATE].

The goal is to confirm whether payment has been scheduled and make it easy to resolve any issue. Include the invoice reference, original due date, payment method or link, and one direct question asking for the expected payment date.

Use a respectful, neutral tone.

Do not mention penalties, legal action, or service suspension unless those instructions are explicitly provided.

Keep the message under 130 words.

Expected output: Short reminder email with invoice details and one clear follow-up question.

Human check: Verify invoice details and make sure the tone matches your business relationship.

04 DOCUMENTS**Notes-to-Professional-Document Converter**

Use this when: You have messy notes and need a usable document or internal memo.

What to provide: raw notes, document type, audience, purpose, required sections

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Convert the notes below into a professional [DOCUMENT TYPE] for [AUDIENCE].

Purpose: [PURPOSE].

Return the result with these sections: [REQUIRED SECTIONS].

Use only the provided notes. Do not invent facts, owners, deadlines, or numbers.

If information is missing, label it 'To confirm'.

At the top, include a short summary of the main point.

NOTES:

[PASTE NOTES]

Expected output: A structured document with clear sections and visible information gaps.

Human check: Check whether the structure fits the audience and whether missing info is clearly marked.



05 DOCUMENTS

Executive Summary Builder

Use this when: You need a concise summary of a longer document for a decision-maker.

What to provide: source document, audience, purpose, length, decision focus

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Create an executive summary of the material below for [AUDIENCE].

The purpose is to help them [DECIDE / UNDERSTAND / APPROVE].

Length: [LENGTH].

Structure the summary with:

1. Purpose
2. Key findings
3. Risks or issues
4. Decisions or actions needed
5. Recommended next step

Separate facts from recommendations.

Do not include unnecessary detail or unsupported conclusions.

SOURCE:

[PASTE DOCUMENT OR NOTES]

Expected output: Decision-ready summary with findings, risks, and next steps.

Human check: Make sure the summary did not hide an important caveat or overstate certainty.

06 DOCUMENTS

SOP Draft Builder

Use this when: You want to turn a spoken explanation or informal process into an SOP.

What to provide: process description, owner, trigger, exceptions, required records

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Using the process explanation below, draft a Standard Operating Procedure.

Structure:

- Purpose
- When to use it
- Required inputs
- Roles
- Numbered steps
- Decision points
- Exceptions
- Escalation
- Records to save
- Completion checklist

Write in plain language and begin each step with an action verb.

Use only the described process. Mark missing details as 'Owner confirmation required'.

PROCESS:

[PASTE PROCESS NOTES]

Expected output: Simple, operational SOP draft with steps and control points.

Human check: Review exceptions, approval points, and missing steps with the process owner.



07 MEETINGS

Meeting Agenda Builder

Use this when: You need an agenda built around outcomes instead of vague discussion topics.

What to provide: meeting purpose, participants, decisions needed, inputs, time available

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Create a meeting agenda for [MEETING PURPOSE].
Participants: [PARTICIPANTS].
Time available: [TIME].
The goal is to help the group make or support these decisions: [DECISIONS NEEDED].
Return:

- meeting objective
- agenda items in order
- time per item
- required pre-read or input
- expected outcome for each item
- items that should not be discussed because they are out of scope

Expected output: Focused agenda with timing, objectives, and expected outcomes.

Human check: Confirm the agenda is realistic and aligned with the actual decision need.

08 MEETINGS

Meeting Notes Organizer

Use this when: You have notes or a transcript and need a structured meeting record.

What to provide: notes or transcript, audience, format preferences

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Using only the meeting notes or transcript below, create a structured meeting record for [AUDIENCE].
Return:

1. Meeting purpose
2. Executive summary
3. Confirmed decisions
4. Action items table with action, owner, deadline, dependency, and status
5. Risks or blockers
6. Open questions
7. Items requiring confirmation

Do not invent owners, deadlines, or decisions. If information is missing, write 'To confirm'.

MEETING NOTES:
[PASTE NOTES]

Expected output: Clean meeting summary with actions, decisions, and open questions.

Human check: Verify owners, dates, and whether any 'decision' was only a discussion point.



09 MEETINGS

Post-Meeting Follow-Up

Use this when: You need a message after a meeting that confirms agreements and next steps.

What to provide: meeting notes, recipient(s), actions, open questions

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Draft a post-meeting follow-up message for [RECIPIENTS] using the notes below.

Goal: confirm what was agreed, keep unresolved items visible, and make next steps clear.

Include:

- brief recap
- confirmed decisions
- actions with owner and deadline
- open questions
- next checkpoint or next meeting

Use a concise, professional tone.

Do not add new actions, dates, or commitments not supported by the notes.

NOTES:

[PASTE NOTES]

Expected output: Clear follow-up message that acts as a working record.

Human check: Check whether every action has an owner and whether any date is missing.

10 ANALYSIS

Information Analysis Prompt

Use this when: You need to analyze notes, data, or a document without losing important nuance.

What to provide: source material, question, output format, decision context

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Analyze the material below to help answer this question: [QUESTION].

Return the result using these sections:

- Confirmed facts
- Patterns or themes
- Anomalies or contradictions
- Key risks or implications
- Missing information
- Supported conclusions
- Recommended next analysis step

Separate facts from interpretation and recommendations.

Do not invent numbers or certainty levels.

SOURCE MATERIAL:

[PASTE MATERIAL]

Expected output: Structured analysis showing evidence, gaps, and implications.

Human check: Confirm that conclusions are traceable to the source material.



11 ANALYSIS

Customer Feedback Analyzer

Use this when: You want to turn reviews or feedback into operational insight.

What to provide: reviews or comments, product/service context, goal

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Analyze the customer feedback below for [PRODUCT / SERVICE].

Goal: identify what should be improved, protected, or investigated further.

For each theme, provide:

- theme name
- frequency
- representative evidence
- likely impact
- severity
- confidence level

Then finish with:

- 3 prioritized improvement actions
- 1 question requiring more data
- 1 strength the business should protect

Do not infer customer demographics or motivations that are not stated.

FEEDBACK:

[PASTE FEEDBACK]

Expected output: Theme-based analysis with frequency, severity, and actions.

Human check: Review whether themes are evidence-based and not over-generalized.

12 ANALYSIS

Process Bottleneck Analyzer

Use this when: You want to identify inefficiencies in a recurring business process.

What to provide: process description, pain points, timing/capacity details, goal

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Review the process described below and identify the main bottlenecks.

Return:

- short summary of the process
- likely bottlenecks
- duplicated work
- waiting points
- unclear handoffs
- manual steps that may be simplified
- likely root causes
- practical improvement ideas

For each improvement, note whether it is a quick fix, medium effort, or higher-effort change.

Do not recommend full automation unless the current conditions support it.

PROCESS:

[PASTE PROCESS DESCRIPTION]

Expected output: Operational diagnosis with practical improvement opportunities.

Human check: Check whether the proposed improvements match real constraints and team capacity.

**13 DECISIONS****Options Comparison Builder**

Use this when: You need to compare alternatives using consistent criteria.

What to provide: options, criteria, weights, source data, decision deadline

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Compare the options below using these criteria and weights: [CRITERIA + WEIGHTS].

Use only the source information provided.

Create a comparison table showing:

- option
- evidence
- score
- weighted score
- key advantages
- key drawbacks
- risks
- missing information

If a criterion cannot be scored, mark 'Insufficient data' and explain the impact.

Finish with a provisional recommendation and the strongest alternative.

OPTIONS:

[PASTE OPTIONS AND DATA]

Expected output: Weighted comparison table and provisional recommendation.

Human check: Review the criteria and make sure missing data is visible before approving.

14 DECISIONS**Better Decision Prompt**

Use this when: You need a more thoughtful evaluation of a business choice.

What to provide: decision question, objective, constraints, options, risks

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Help evaluate this decision: [DECISION QUESTION].

Objective: [OBJECTIVE].

Constraints: [CONSTRAINTS].

Options: [OPTIONS].

Return:

- decision goal
- evaluation criteria
- option-by-option analysis
- upside
- downside
- key risks
- reversibility
- second-order consequences
- what we still do not know
- provisional recommendation

Do not pretend certainty where there is uncertainty.

Flag assumptions clearly.

Expected output: Balanced decision analysis rather than a simplistic recommendation.

Human check: Check whether the recommendation fits your authority, risk appetite, and actual constraints.

**15 DECISIONS****Pre-Mortem Prompt**

Use this when: You want to stress-test a plan before moving forward.

What to provide: plan or initiative, goal, timeline, key assumptions

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Assume the following initiative failed badly six months from now: [PLAN / INITIATIVE].
Goal: identify likely causes early enough to reduce the risk now.

Return:

- most likely failure scenarios
- early warning signs
- root causes
- assumptions that may be wrong
- consequences if the failure occurs
- preventive actions
- contingency actions

Rank the top 5 risks by likely impact and controllability.

Expected output: Pre-mortem analysis with risks, signals, and preventive steps.

Human check: Review whether the top risks reflect reality or only the most obvious concerns.

16 FOLLOW-UP**Client Follow-Up After a Call**

Use this when: You need a follow-up that keeps a client conversation moving forward.

What to provide: call notes, client name, agreed points, next step options

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Using only the call notes below, draft a follow-up email to [CLIENT NAME].

Goal: confirm what was discussed and make the next step easy.

Include:

- short recap
- confirmed points
- unanswered questions
- information or documents needed
- 1 to 2 clear next-step options

Use a warm, professional tone.

Do not invent prices, deadlines, or promises.

CALL NOTES:

[PASTE NOTES]

Expected output: Relationship-friendly follow-up email with momentum and clarity.

Human check: Verify what is confirmed versus what still needs validation.



17 FOLLOW-UP

No-Response Follow-Up

Use this when: Someone has not replied and you need a professional reminder.

What to provide: original context, recipient, desired action, timing

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Draft a follow-up message for [RECIPIENT].

Context: [ORIGINAL CONTEXT].

The message should politely remind them, restate the main point, and make the requested action clear.

Return 3 versions:

1. gentle reminder
2. direct follow-up
3. final close-the-loop message

Keep each version concise and professional.

Do not sound passive-aggressive or robotic.

Expected output: Three levels of follow-up for different communication contexts.

Human check: Choose the version that matches the relationship and urgency.

18 PLANNING

Weekly Priority Planner

Use this when: You need to turn a long list of work into a realistic weekly plan.

What to provide: task list, deadlines, capacity, fixed commitments, priorities

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Create a realistic weekly plan from the items below.

Constraints:

- team capacity: [CAPACITY]
- fixed commitments: [COMMITMENTS]
- deadlines: [DEADLINES]

Return:

- 5 primary outcomes for the week
- must-do tasks
- should-do tasks
- can defer
- owner
- due date
- first action
- blockers or dependencies

Do not schedule more than the stated capacity allows.

Flag conflicts and suggest one trade-off where necessary.

Expected output: Weekly priorities with capacity awareness and trade-offs.

Human check: Confirm the plan is realistic and not overloaded.



19 PLANNING

Action Plan Builder

Use this when: You need to turn a goal into a practical sequence of work.

What to provide: goal, deadline, constraints, resources, owner(s)

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Build an action plan for this goal: [GOAL].

Deadline: [DEADLINE].

Constraints: [CONSTRAINTS].

Available resources: [RESOURCES].

Return:

- final objective
- milestones
- activities under each milestone
- sequence
- owner
- deadline
- dependencies
- completion criteria
- major risks

If information is missing, label it clearly instead of guessing.

Expected output: Structured action plan with milestones and ownership.

Human check: Review dependencies, workload, and whether completion criteria are measurable.

20 PLANNING

Daily Operations Digest

Use this when: You want one clear summary of operational activity, issues, and priorities.

What to provide: team updates, completed work, issues, risks, next priorities

COPY & CUSTOMIZE

Create a daily operations digest from the updates below.

Return:

- summary of completed work
- current issues
- risks or blockers
- overdue actions
- decisions needed
- priorities for the next day or week
- items requiring escalation

Use concise business language and avoid repetition. Do not invent progress, status, or deadlines.

UPDATES:

[PASTE TEAM UPDATES]

Expected output: Readable operational summary for fast decision support.

Human check: Check that the digest reflects real issues and did not hide uncertainty.



Human review still matters.

These prompts improve the work. They do not inherit your authority or accountability.

- | | |
|--------------------------|--|
| ☐ | Are all names, dates, amounts, and commitments supported by the source information? |
| ☐ | Did the AI invent a fact, owner, deadline, risk level, or recommendation? |
| ☐ | Are facts, assumptions, interpretations, and recommendations clearly separated? |
| ☐ | Could the output create an unauthorized promise to a client, vendor, or colleague? |
| ☐ | Does the result include confidential or sensitive information that should not be shared? |
| ☐ | If the task affects money, staffing, compliance, or contracts, has the accountable person reviewed it? |

Rule of thumb: the more the output can affect trust, money, delivery, or obligations, the more carefully it should be reviewed.



One prompt can improve one task. A repeatable workflow can improve the work every time.

Use this guide to improve one recurring activity in your business or team: a follow-up, a meeting recap, a status update, a vendor comparison, a customer response, or a weekly planning routine.

EXPLORE MORE FREE RESOURCES OR REQUEST A MINI WORKFLOW REVIEW

<https://aipmlab.propertydex.xyz>

Related resources in the AI PM Lab library:

- Before You Prompt: The Clarity Checklist
- The One Prompt Framework You Actually Need
- From Vague Request to Professional Prompt

AI PM Lab by Trigosat Consulting | Practical AI workflows. Clear operations. Human control.